

DOCUMENTATION – SENSOLI [ENGLISH VERSION]

INTRODUCTION

Sensoli is a free application intended for personal productivity tracking and analysis. The core of its operation relies on detecting the applications currently in use. This detection makes it possible to create the data required for the application to operate and to produce the corresponding user statistics. To do so, Sensoli uses macOS APIs to receive application activation/change notifications. It uses this information only to identify the active application and its associated bundle identifier. The main purpose of Sensoli is to provide a tool that allows different users to classify their applications into three categories: productive, neutral, or distracting, while leaving each user free to decide how applications should be classified and allowing this arbitrary classification to be modified at any time.

Sensoli is built around three main modules: analysis, recommendations, and tracking. The analysis is based on the user's activity at the application level, not on the content of those applications. Recommendations are based on the analyses performed and help the user understand what happened during their sessions by suggesting actions and highlighting certain aspects that would be difficult to measure without a dedicated tool. The tracking module allows users to organize their work at the project level. Each user can provide various types of information about their projects and add tasks to them, allowing them to track their work directly within the application.

GETTING STARTED

By downloading Sensoli, you gain access to numerous features, including session analysis and various personal metrics. In order to obtain information about your sessions, you must allow Sensoli to detect the applications you use. To make this process as simple as possible, Sensoli has been designed to require minimal effort. You only need to use an application at least once, even for a very short period, and Sensoli will detect it. The default type is neutral.

If you wish to change the type of an application, which we recommend, you can simply go to the Settings page in the application, change its type by selecting the appropriate checkbox, and save your changes. We also recommend carrying out a detection session in which you use the applications you intend to use, so that they are already detected and ready for your upcoming sessions.

A new application may be detected during a session, and Sensoli handles this situation by assigning it the neutral type, which is the default type.

CREATING YOUR FIRST SESSION

Once you have updated your applications in Settings, you can start a session from the Analysis page by clicking the corresponding blue button. During the session, you are free to carry out your usual activities.

To end the session, simply click the corresponding button to stop the analysis. A report in .pdf format will then open. The PDF report contains various useful pieces of information to help

you understand your session, as well as the session identification number, which can also be found in your history. This number is important and cannot be changed.

If you forget to close a session, Sensoli is designed to save your activity locally with a delay of no more than 10 seconds. Therefore, if your computer crashes, is shut down, or if you close the application without ending the current session, your activity will still be available for analysis, with a maximum delay of 10 seconds. This makes it possible to obtain a report that accurately represents your session.

UNDERSTANDING SESSION ANALYSIS

Sensoli provides several indicators. To understand your analysis, we recommend paying close attention to them and taking the time to review the different metrics carefully and calmly, allowing you to develop a clear understanding of what they represent and where they appear.

The main indicators are as follows:

- **Session Duration:** represents the amount of time between the beginning and the end of the analysis. There is no time limit. However, please note that prolonged sessions or sessions involving an unusually large number of applications may result in information overload in the corresponding graphs at the end of the analysis (two of the nine graphs may be affected).
- **Sequences:** a sequence is defined as a period of time whose boundaries correspond to the beginning of the session, the end of a sequence, and the end of the session. The end of a sequence is defined by a temporal separation occurring after the use of *an application classified as distracting for more than two minutes*. Therefore, using a distracting application for two minutes and one second will create a new sequence, and that application will be the first event of that sequence.
- **Best Sequence and Duration:** the best sequence is defined as the longest sequence without interruption by a distracting application. Please note that it is possible to obtain a single best sequence consisting exclusively of the use of a distracting application. This situation will nevertheless be indicated.
- **Fragmentation:** fragmentation represents the number of transitions between sequences. The higher this value, the less focused the session appears to be.
- **Score:** the score is an arbitrary Sensoli metric, and we expressly disclaim any representation that it measures human cognitive concentration in a scientific or otherwise objective manner. It is based solely on the other indicators and may therefore be inappropriate in certain situations. It should not be taken at face value. A higher score is generally interpreted as better, but please keep in mind that this is only an algorithmic interpretation. The score should be considered as information, not as a truth or a faithful representation of the quality of your work.
- **Changes:** a change is a transition from one application to another. It is measured throughout your activity and is intended to indicate how often your main working window changes. The lower this value is, the more focused activity within a single window may appear to be. However, it is entirely possible that highly focused work may require frequent changes between applications, and Sensoli cannot determine this. Therefore, like the other indicators, this metric should be considered informational. It can nevertheless be compared with other statistics and graphs to support a subjective interpretation.

- **Usage Duration:** the usage duration of an application represents the time spent using that application between different changes. Please note that this value is indicative and has limitations. If an application is relevant to your current work but you are not actively doing anything in it, Sensoli cannot know this. You are therefore free to interpret this information as you see fit. Sensoli does not monitor you; it only measures what is technically possible through Apple's official notifications, without special access to your activity such as keystrokes, mouse movements, or similar information.
- **Transition:** a transition is a change from one application to another. Sensoli provides the most frequently occurring transition, which may provide potentially useful information about your activity.
- **Specific Hour:** a specific hour is associated with your best sequence. For example, if a sequence begins at 10:00, its specific hour is 10, allowing you to interpret this information according to your own habits.
- **Recurrence:** recurrence refers to the repeated occurrence of an action, such as changes, applications used, the starting hours of best sequences, or other events.

Please note the term “**timeline**”.

- In the PDF report, the timeline is divided into sequences, and the time spent on applications is aggregated while the applications retain their order of use. As a result, a distracting application may have an aggregated value of more than two minutes without creating a new sequence, because this value represents its accumulated usage time (for example, several periods of 20 seconds).
- In the application, the timeline reflects the recorded activity from beginning to end and is proportional to the actual elapsed time. It shows each occurrence of an application, its usage duration, and its type in the form of a timeline, without aggregating usage periods. The recorded times therefore remain faithful to the activity. For example, if an application is used for a total of 5 minutes through the following periods: 1 minute, 30 seconds, 2 minutes, and 1 minute 30 seconds, these individual periods will be displayed separately rather than as a single 5-minute period, unlike in the PDF report.

METRICS AFTER ANALYSIS

The information generated after an analysis can be found on the main Dashboard, displayed as daily data together with a trend indicator based on the last 14 sessions.

Various pieces of information are also available in the main Productivity tab, based on a comparison with the last 10 sessions. These include total time, the most frequently used applications and their type (the type corresponds to your current Settings), the number of changes during the last session, the most frequently used distracting application, and other information.

More detailed information is available in the dedicated Productivity tab. To access it, enter the identifier of the relevant session. You will then find various precise metrics, such as the distribution of time, the application most used during the “best” sequence, the hours with the most or fewest changes, the application with the highest number of switches, the most

frequent transition, and other information. These metrics are based on the recorded activity and can be interpreted according to your own habits.

Two timelines are available: the timeline of your most recent session and another timeline specific to a session identifier that you can enter. You can then compare them.

After an analysis, your interface is automatically updated across each tab and reflects the current state of your metrics. Data associated with a session can no longer be modified, in order to preserve the integrity and authenticity of the recorded information.

TEXTUAL COACHING CENTER

The Recommendations tab provides statements based on your activity. This allows you to obtain specific information and recommendations in the form of clear, concise, and carefully worded statements, providing a centralized summary of your activity. Links are established between the different indicators.

The purpose of this tab is to help you quickly understand your session and current trends simply by reading the information provided.

GRAPHS AND COMPARISONS

Sensoli provides 9 graphs:

- **Changes per Minute and Best Sequence Duration:** this graph is displayed on the main Dashboard. It establishes a relationship between your application change rate and the duration of each best sequence, allowing you to reflect on patterns such as, for example: the fewer changes I make per minute, the longer my best sequence tends to be.
- **Main Graphs Tab:**
 - **Scores:** evolution of your score over the last 14 sessions.
 - **Usage Distribution:** average proportion of the different application types, based on the settings recorded for each session at the time it was created, over the last 14 sessions.
 - **Fragmentation:** fragmentation rate over the last 14 sessions.
 - **Best Sequence Duration:** duration of the sequences recorded during each of the last 14 sessions.
 - **Specific Hours:** represents the hours at which the best sequences occurred during the last 14 sessions. The higher the bar, the more frequently that hour was associated with a best sequence.
 - **Number of Changes:** number of application transitions during each of the last 14 sessions.
- **In the PDF report:**
 - **Application Histogram:** usage duration of the different applications and a visual comparison of their proportions.
 - **Number of Changes per Minute:** visualization of your change rate over the entire session.

A comparison is performed between the selected session and your average activity over the last 14 sessions on the Analysis page of the Coaching Center.

A second comparison is performed in the main Graphs tab, based on your activity across two consecutive periods of equal length within your most recent sessions. When 14 sessions are available, this compares your last 7 sessions with the 7 sessions preceding them. With fewer sessions, the available sessions are divided into two equally sized periods. This provides a comparison of how your activity evolves over time.

GENERATED SESSIONS

Based on your average activity over the last 14 sessions (an arbitrary reference), Sensoli can provide typical session templates corresponding to the selected indicators (score, productivity, and distracting activity). It will then suggest indicator values to aim for.

You may consider the proposed sessions unsuitable or simply not wish to use them, in which case you can create a session as usual. The only difference is that a simple comparison will be performed at the end of the session. The core of this module, however, lies in the proposals, which are generated using a specific algorithm that can create up to three sessions for you. It is also possible that no session will be proposed if the available data is not sufficiently meaningful.

This feature was designed in particular for situations where you are satisfied with your current activity and wish to continue working in a similar way. For example, you might think: “I’m happy with how my sessions have been going lately. How can I obtain a similar productivity report?”

WORKSPACES AND PROJECTS

The Workspace tab allows you to organize and track your sessions.

You can create a project by providing its name, the relevant time period, and a description. You can then associate average indicator values with it. For example, you could define an average fragmentation of 5 for the project.

Once you click Create, the project can no longer be modified. We therefore recommend paying close attention when creating a project. Each project can be deleted.

By clicking on a project, you can view its average statistics as well as the goals that were defined for it.

A project can have one of four possible statuses: Active, Inactive, Completed, or Finished. These statuses are purely visual and are used to sort your projects on the Management page.

A maximum of 12 projects can be created. When creating a session, you can select the project associated with the upcoming session.

To manage detailed information about a project, go to the Management tab. To select a project, choose its type and title.

Once this has been done, you can fill in the various fields, including project managers, people involved, location, next action, and general information.

You can then manually enter a deadline using the following format: DD/MM/YYYY (day, month, year). For example: 28/05/2026. You can also select a date from the calendar, which will update the field automatically.

You can define a project priority from 0 to 100.

Click Save to apply these changes.

Up to 5 tasks can be defined for each project. To add tasks, click Add and save each task using the Save button on its corresponding row. To delete a task, simply click the cross.

Once a task is completed, click its checkbox and a symbol will appear. Please save the change afterwards.

GOALS

In the Goals tab, you can create up to 6 goals. These goals are available in different categories depending on what you want to improve: total time, best sequence (focus duration), application usage (time), category usage time, and fragmentation.

Goals are automatically updated and tracked based on both the most recent session and the last 5 sessions.

A goal can be removed at any time by clicking the corresponding button on its card.

REPORTS

PDF reports contain various pieces of information and are automatically generated once a session is completed or retrieved.

You can also generate reports for previous sessions by entering the relevant session identifier on the Analysis page.

You can additionally add a comment to a report. This can be done after a session and is the only modification available to the user, allowing them to provide clarification, an explanation, or other additional information.

Reports are stored in an application folder belonging to the user, but they can also be actively saved to a folder of your choice at any time.

Privacy and Data Protection

Sensoli operates locally. No data is sent to a server.

Sensoli relies on official macOS application-change notifications to identify which application is currently active. It does not inspect the content of those applications. We store a username, the account creation date, and application changes together with their corresponding times, and only this information.

We do not know what you do within your applications or what content you view. We only retrieve the application name and its bundle identifier, for example: Sensoli, com.leman.sensoli, together with the date and time (hour, minute, second, microsecond, day, month, and year).

Passwords are hashed and are never stored in plain text.

A username is unique locally.

We do not provide your data to third parties, in particular because we do not have access to your data and no specific mechanism has been designed to do so.

You can delete selected sessions at any time or permanently delete your account. You can also export your data in JSON and CSV formats.

TROUBLESHOOTING

If you need assistance with troubleshooting, we recommend consulting this documentation or seeking help from a third party.

If necessary, you may contact us for assistance, subject to availability and response times.

Contact address: sensoli.app@outlook.com

DISCLAIMERS

We make every effort to limit the information used by Sensoli to what is necessary for its operation and to provide a simple and clear experience.

Sensoli is designed to operate locally. Data relating to your activity is not sent to a server. The application only uses the information necessary for its operation, such as the name of the active application, its bundle identifier, the date and time of the application change, and the information required for local session and account identification.

Sensoli is free software intended for personal productivity tracking and analysis. It is not designed to be used as a surveillance tool for another person. Any unlawful, abusive, or otherwise unauthorized use of the application is prohibited.

However, we cannot guarantee that no technical issue, data loss, or failure will ever occur. We cannot be held responsible for consequences resulting from modification of the software or from using Sensoli for purposes other than those for which it was designed, to the extent permitted by applicable law.

Sensoli is distributed through the Apple App Store and was developed in Switzerland in compliance with applicable rules and laws.

THIRD-PARTY SOFTWARE & OPEN SOURCE LICENSES

Sensoli uses several open-source software components. These components are distributed under their respective licenses. Sensoli is distributed in accordance with the applicable terms and conditions of these licenses.

PySide6 / Qt for Python

Version: 6.11.1

License: LGPLv3 / GPLv3 / Commercial

Sensoli uses PySide6 (Qt for Python) to provide its graphical user interface and application framework.

Qt for Python is available under the GNU Lesser General Public License version 3 (LGPLv3), the GNU General Public License version 3 (GPLv3), or commercial Qt licensing, depending on the applicable licensing option.

The LGPL permits the use of Qt for Python in proprietary applications provided that the applicable LGPL requirements are respected.

Official project and licensing information:

<https://doc.qt.io/qtforpython-6/>

Shiboken6

Version: 6.11.1

License: LGPLv3 / GPLv3 / Commercial

Shiboken6 is part of the Qt for Python project and is used by Sensoli as part of the PySide6 ecosystem.

It is covered by the applicable Qt for Python licensing terms, including the LGPLv3, GPLv3, and commercial licensing options.

Official project and licensing information:

<https://doc.qt.io/qtforpython-6/>

PyObjC

Version: 12.2.1

License: MIT

Sensoli uses PyObjC to interact with macOS frameworks and native macOS functionality.

PyObjC is distributed under the MIT License, which permits use, modification and redistribution, including in commercial and proprietary software, subject to the conditions of the license.

Official project and licensing information:

<https://pypi.org/project/pyobjc/>

Matplotlib

Version: 3.10.9

License: Matplotlib License (PSF-based / BSD-compatible)

Sensoli uses Matplotlib to generate charts and data visualizations.

Matplotlib is distributed under a permissive license that permits use, modification and redistribution, including in commercial software, subject to the applicable license conditions and notices.

Official licensing information:

<https://matplotlib.org/stable/project/license.html>

NumPy

Version: 2.2.6

License: BSD License

Sensoli uses NumPy for numerical computations and data processing. NumPy is distributed under a permissive BSD license that permits commercial and proprietary use, subject to the applicable license conditions. Official licensing information: <https://numpy.org/doc/stable/license.html>

SciPy

Version: 1.15.3

License: BSD License

Sensoli uses SciPy for scientific and numerical computations, including data interpolation. SciPy is distributed under a permissive BSD license that permits commercial and non-commercial use, subject to the applicable license conditions.

Official licensing information:

<https://scipy.org/scipylib/license.html>

ReportLab

Version: 5.0.0

License: BSD License

Sensoli uses ReportLab to generate PDF reports.

The open-source ReportLab Toolkit is distributed under the BSD license and may be used in commercial software, subject to the applicable license conditions.

Official licensing information:

<https://docs.reportlab.com/developerfaqs/>

bcrypt

Version: 5.0.0

License: Apache License 2.0

Sensoli uses bcrypt for password hashing and local authentication.

The Apache License 2.0 is a permissive open-source license that allows commercial and proprietary use, modification and redistribution, subject to its conditions and required notices.

Official licensing information:

<https://pypi.org/project/bcrypt/>

Build and Packaging Software

PyInstaller

Version: 6.22.1

License: GNU General Public License v2.0 with a specific exception

PyInstaller is used during the development and build process to package Sensoli and its Python dependencies into a macOS application bundle.

PyInstaller is not a runtime library used directly by Sensoli. Its license includes an exception that allows PyInstaller to be used to bundle commercial applications. Executable bundles generated by PyInstaller may be distributed under the applicable license of the application, provided that the licenses of the bundled dependencies are respected.

Official licensing information:

<https://pyinstaller.org/en/stable/license.html>

License Compliance

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